

TEXT OF TELEGRAM 86MOSCOW017836

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CONFIDENTIAL

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ACTION EUR-00

INFO LOG-00 COPY-01 ADS-00 INR-10 SS-00 CIAE-00 OODE-00
H-01 10-19 NSCE-00 N*AE-00 SSO-00 HA-09 I-03
PM-10 PA-01* OMB-01 INRE-00 ACOA-12 USIE-00 SP-02
SNP-01 PRS-01 /071 W

O 151719Z OCT 86

FM AMEMBASSY MOSCOW

TO SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 1776

INFO MOSCOW POLITICAL COLLECTIVE PRIORITY

AMEMBASSY REYKJAVIK

C O N F I D E N T I A L SECTION 01 OF 02 MOSCOW 17836

E.O. 12356: DECLASS. AUTH.

TAGS: PREL, PARM, UR, J

SUBJECT: COMMENTARY ON GORBACHEV'S OCTOBER 14 SPEECH

*1. CONFIDENTIAL - ENTIRE TEXT.

SUMMARY *****

2. IN A SIXTY-FIVE MINUTE TELEVISED SPEECH THE EVENING OF OCTOBER 14, GORBACHEV LAID OUT THE SOVIET VERSION OF WHAT HAPPENED AT THE REYKJAVIK MEETING. PREDICTABLY, HE CONCLUDED THAT U.S. INSISTENCE ON SOI PREVENTED A MAJOR BREAKTHROUGH ON ARMS CONTROL. HOWEVER, BY SETTING THE SOI QUESTION IN STARK RELIEF, GORBACHEV WAS ALSO SAYING THAT THE REMAINING DIFFERENCES ARE SMALL IN CONTRAST TO THE AGREEMENTS REACHED ON OTHER ISSUES. AND OVERCOMING THESE DIFFERENCES AFTER A COOLING-OFF PERIOD WAS STILL POSSIBLE GIVEN U.S. WILLINGNESS TO COMPROMISE. INTERNATIONALLY, THE SPEECH CONSTITUTED STAGE TWO IN THE SOVIETS' PUBLIC DIPLOMACY CAMPAIGN FOR U.S. AND ALLIED AUDIENCES, AS WELL AS RESPONDING TO U.S. VERSIONS OF THE REYKJAVIK CONFIDENTIAL *****
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EVENTS. DOMESTICALLY, THE

END SUMMARY

3. ADDRESSEES WILL HAVE ALREADY RECEIVED FBIS TEXT OF GORBACHEV'S OCTOBER 14 TELEVISED ADDRESS TO THE NATION

PAGE NO. 1

EXCISE

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DEPARTMENT OF STATE A/CDC/MR

DECLASSIFIED by JA DATE 11/17/89
() DECLASSIFY
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() Exemptions: (b)(1) (4) (5)
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ON THE REYKJAVIK MEETING. THE SPEECH WAS ESSENTIALLY A REITERATION AND EXTENSION OF THE LINE HE TOOK AT HIS PRESS CONFERENCE IN REYKJAVIK ON SUNDAY WITH THE FOLLOWING EXCEPTIONS.

4. *61 05*

THIS WAS EVIDENT IN:

--HIS CAREFUL AND DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF HOW HE HANDLED THE SERIES OF MEETINGS WITH PRESIDENT REAGAN IN REYKJAVIK;

--HIS SOMETIMES SHARP DEPICTION OF SPECIFIC EXCHANGES WITH THE PRESIDENT;

--HIS EMPHASIS ON THE WIDESPREAD PREPARATION AND SUPPORT OF THE SOVIET POSITION GOING INTO REYKJAVIK;

--HIS IDEOLOGICAL EXPLANATIONS OF WHY THE U.S. WAS NOT WILLING TO TAKE THE FINAL STEP TOWARD AGREEMENT;

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AND

--HIS INSISTENCE THAT THE MEETING HAD NOT BEEN A FAILURE.

IDEOLOGICAL INTERPRETATIONS LABEL AS "DELUSIONS" ANY U.S. BELIEF THAT IT CAN DICTATE TO THE USSR, THAT THE USSR NEEDS ARMS CONTROL MORE THAN THE U.S., OR THAT AN ARMS RACE WOULD PRESSURE THE USSR.

5. GORBACHEV PULLED NO PUNCHES IN POINTING THE FINGER DIRECTLY AT SOI AS THE SINGLE OBSTACLE TO MAJOR ARMS REDUCTION. THIS, HE SAID, WAS THE MOST IMPORTANT LESSON FROM REYKJAVIK. HIS DETAILED ACCOUNT OF THE PROCEEDINGS SERVED TO ILLUSTRATE DRAMATICALLY HOW NARROWLY FOCUSED THE REMAINING DIFFERENCES WERE ON SOI -- "ONLY TWO OR THREE STEPS AWAY" FROM A CONTRACT ON NUCLEAR WEAPONS REDUCTIONS THAT WOULD

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GORBACHEV ALSO CRITICIZES THE PRESIDENT POINTEDLY, AT ONE STAGE CALLING HIM WOEFULLY UNINFORMED "TO PUT IT MILDLY."

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	PM-10	PA-01	OMG-01	INRE-00	ACOA-12	USIE-00	SP-02
	SNP-01	PRS-01	/071 W				

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FM AMEMBASSY MOSCOW
TO SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 1777
INFO MOSCOW POLITICAL COLLECTIVE PRIORITY
AMEMBASSY REYKJAVIK

C 7 N F I D E N T I A L SECTION 02 OF 02 MOSCOW 17836

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6. GORBACHEV ALSO REACTED IN SEVERAL PASSAGES TO REMARKS BY PRESIDENT REAGAN AFTER REYKJAVIK, INDICATING THAT HE IS WATCHING CLOSELY WHAT IS BEING SAID IN THE U.S. AND INTENDS TO KEEP HIS SIDE OF THE STORY ACTIVELY ON THE PUBLIC RECORD. HE DESCRIBED HIS DETAILED ACCOUNT OF THE REYKJAVIK PROCEEDINGS AS AN ATTEMPT TO SET THE RECORD STRAIGHT BECAUSE, HE SAID, THE U.S. SIDE SEEMED TO BE TAKING CREDIT AT HOME FOR ALL THE PROPOSALS MADE IN REYKJAVIK. HIS PUBLIC RELEASE OF THE SOVIET TEXT ON ABM TREATY NON-WITHDRAWAL, WHICH SPEAKS OF PROHIBITING "THE TESTING OF ALL SPACE ELEMENTS OF MISSILE DEFENSE IN SPACE, EXCEPT FOR RESEARCH AND TESTING CONDUCTED IN LABORATORIES," SEEMS DESIGNED TO SHOW THAT THE SOVIET PROPOSAL WAS NOT AS RESTRICTIVE AS U.S. STATEMENTS HAD INDICATED.

7. AS IN REYKJAVIK, GORBACHEV REINFORCED THE POSITIVE
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BY DECLARING THAT, DESPITE THE FAILURE TO REACH FINAL AGREEMENT, THE EFFORT HAD NOT BEEN IN VAIN, A QUANTITATIVELY NEW SITUATION HAD DEVELOPED, AND "NO ONE CAN ACT ANY LONGER AS HE ACTED BEFORE," ALTHOUGH PERHAPS LESS OPTIMISTIC THAN IN REYKJAVIK, HE SAID IN A CONCILIATORY GESTURE THAT "THE U.S. LEADERSHIP NEEDS SOME TIME. WE UNDERSTAND THAT QUESTIONS WHICH HAVE REMAINED UNSOLVED FOR SO MANY YEARS CAN HARDLY BE RESOLVED IN A SINGLE SETTING." HARTMAN

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